READING UNIT 5

The Future of Operating Systems

Operating systems have gone through many important changes over the last few decades. In the early 2000s, computers still depended on traditional systems that focused mainly on running basic programs and managing files. These systems were useful, but they were not very flexible, and users often needed some technical knowledge to operate them comfortably.

Everything began to change when smartphones became popular. People no longer wanted to use technology only at home or in the office as they wanted to carry it everywhere. This led to the development of new mobile operating systems that were faster, more intuitive, and easier to use. Apple introduced iOS, and Google launched Android. Both systems completely transformed daily life by giving people instant access to maps, messages, social networks, and thousands of apps. For the first time, users could perform tasks that previously required a computer directly from their pockets.

During the 2010s, another technological revolution appeared: cloud computing. This new model changed how information was stored and processed. Instead of saving files on a local hard drive, users could keep everything online and access it from any device. This idea inspired the creation of cloud-based operating systems. Chrome OS is one of the most popular examples. It was designed for lightweight laptops that do not need powerful processors because most of the work happens on remote servers. As a result, these laptops can be cheaper, faster to update, and more accessible for students and everyday users.

Today, operating systems are evolving again as artificial intelligence becomes part of modern technology. AI tools can organize files, suggest what the user might want to do next, and even provide security by analysing unusual activity. These smart features help users save time and avoid mistakes.

Experts believe that in the near future, operating systems will become even more personalized. Instead of being the same for everyone, they may learn your routine, understand when you prefer to work, and adjust the device's settings automatically. They might also move from one device to another, so your experience stays the same whether you are using a phone, a laptop, a smartwatch, or even a smart home system. In other words, the operating system will "follow you" wherever you go, making technology more natural and comfortable to use.

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QUESTIONS:

1. Read the text and answer these questions:

a. Why did mobile operating systems become necessary?

b. Which two companies released the most successful mobile systems?

c. What is the main advantage of cloud-based operating systems?

d. Why can Chromebooks use less powerful hardware?

e. How is artificial intelligence helping modern operating systems?

f. What changes might future operating systems make to adapt to users?